Lesson notes · for you

Sort it into a table

Data engineering · Level 1 · Lesson 2

Time
15 min

Materials
Paper, a pencil and a ruler; A phone or tablet with Darsi, for the lab

Learning goals

- Read a table: rows, columns and cells.
- Sort data into a table with headings.
- Fix a table so a computer counts it right.

Activity: Our garden table

1. Look (3 min): Read out five scraps, such as “Monday 6 beans” and “Tuesday 2 maize”. Can anyone say the best day?
2. Draw (5 min): Draw a table with a row for each day and a column for each crop, each with a heading.
3. Fill (4 min): Move each scrap into the right cell.
4. Find (3 min): Use the table to find the best day for beans, and the best day overall.

Prepare the scraps of paper before the lesson, with made-up numbers.

Discussion

- Why is a table easier to read than scraps of paper?
- What goes wrong with two facts in one cell?
- How did we find the best day?

Check yourself

- Draw a table with two rows and two columns, and label a row, a column and a cell.

Try it this week
Make a table of your week: one row for each day, and columns for the weather and how you got to school.

Worksheet

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **One cell says "3 and 5": the beans and the tomatoes. What's wrong?**

◯ Two facts in one cell ◯ Nothing is wrong ◯ The numbers are too small

2 **Match each word to what it means.**

Row	• • • •	The name at the top of a column
Column	• • • •	Where a row meets a column: one fact
Heading	• • • •	Goes across: one day or one pupil
Cell	• • • •	Goes down: one kind of fact

3 **A Total row in the middle of a table helps the computer count.**

◯ True ◯ False

4 **Our garden table: on Monday we picked 6 beans and 4 tomatoes; on Tuesday, 3 beans and 5 tomatoes. On which day did we pick more beans?**

◯ Monday ◯ Tuesday ◯ The same on both days

5 **Which of these make a good table? Choose all that apply.**

☐ One fact in each cell ☐ Two numbers in one cell ☐ A heading on every column

☐ One row for each day

✎ **What could you put in a table at home or at school?**

_____

_____

_____

Check your answers

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1 **Two facts in one cell**

Each cell holds one fact. Give beans and tomatoes a column each.

2 **Row — Goes across: one day or one pupil**
Column — Goes down: one kind of fact
Heading — The name at the top of a column
Cell — Where a row meets a column: one fact

Rows go across and columns go down. The heading names a column, and each cell holds one fact.

3 **False**

The computer thinks the Total row is one more thing to count, so it gets the answer wrong.

4 **Monday**

Look down the beans column: 6 on Monday and 3 on Tuesday.

5 **A heading on every column; One fact in each cell; One row for each day**

Headings, one fact per cell and one row per day make a table easy to read and to count.